

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Medical Devices English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For medical device engineers, product managers, quality and regulatory staff, clinical specialists, manufacturing teams, field-service teams, and device-company leaders.

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 User Needs and Design Inputs

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

03 Verification, Validation, and Design Review

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

04 Usability and Human Factors

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

05 Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

06 Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

07 Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

08 Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

State a concern respectfully and propose a practical route forward.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

User Needs and Design Inputs

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A design brief says the device should be "easy to use." It does not identify the intended users or use environment.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: user need, design input, intended use, traceability.

Model response

Who will use it, for which task, and in what environment? Let's turn "easy to use" into specific user needs and requirements that the team can review.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. C - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 • Conversations

1. Easy to use for whom? - Fictional design-planning meeting: the brief says easy to use but names neither intended users nor the use environment.
2. A readable screen under which conditions? - Separate fictional device case: a portable reader is intended for trained technicians in a bright clinic room; the brief says readable without specifying distance or display content.
3. A user preference mistaken for an approved input - Separate fictional design review: one technician requested a larger carrying handle; no broader user assessment or approved design input exists.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A one-handed requirement without a task

A fictional design brief requests one-handed operation but does not specify which task or why one hand is occupied. The intended users are clinic technicians. Clarify the task before proposing a design input.

Role A: Design engineer: ask which operation must be performed and under what conditions.

Role B: Product specialist: distinguish the stated request from information that still needs user research.

Possible opening: Which task needs one-handed operation, and what is the technician doing with the other hand?

Success checks

- Clarify the task and use conditions.
- Avoid expanding the intended requirement without evidence.
- Agree how the verified need will connect to a testable design input.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to apply the requirement to every device interaction.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

A risk discussion uses hazard and harm interchangeably. The team needs to describe the potential source of harm and the possible outcome separately.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: hazard, harm, FMEA, residual risk.

Model response

Let's distinguish the hazard from the harm that could result. That will help us describe the sequence clearly and discuss the controls without treating the two terms as synonyms.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. B - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.
2. A - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

05 • Conversations

1. Hazard and harm are not interchangeable - Fictional risk-language exercise: a design worksheet mixes the potential source of harm with the possible resulting injury; no operational safety instructions are practiced.
2. A failure mode is not the resulting injury - Separate fictional FMEA exercise: a display could freeze, an operator could read an outdated value, and an inappropriate decision is a possible downstream consequence; likelihoods

are unknown.

3. A control proposed versus a control shown effective - Separate fictional design meeting: a warning label is proposed as a risk control, but no evaluation of its effectiveness has been completed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An event count without an exposure count

A fictional post-design risk discussion mentions two reported incidents but gives no number of devices or uses. The team wants to describe the probability of harm as low. Discuss the missing basis for that statement.

Role A: Risk analyst: explain what the incident count does and does not establish.

Role B: Design manager: ask for the relevant exposure and event definitions before interpreting likelihood.

Possible opening: Two reports tell us the count, but not the probability without an appropriate exposure basis.

Success checks

- Separate event count from probability.
- Do not treat absent reports as proof of zero risk.
- Agree the evidence needed for the risk review.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to enter zero residual risk because no additional reports are known.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Verification, Validation, and Design Review

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

CASE

A device team has checked design outputs against specifications but has not yet completed the planned evaluation of intended user needs.

Teach this move

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Vocabulary to check: verification, validation, design review, acceptance criteria.

Model response

The specification checks address verification. They do not by themselves answer every validation question about intended use. I'll report those activities separately and identify what remains open.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. 'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Second-round challenge

Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Language-check answers

1. A - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less. 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.
2. C - An increase of one percentage point. Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

05 · Conversations

1. Specifications checked, user needs still under evaluation - Fictional design review: outputs have been checked against specifications; the planned evaluation of intended user needs is incomplete.
2. Bench timing versus task completion with users - Separate fictional planning case: a bench test measures button response time; a proposed user study measures whether technicians complete the intended setup task.

3. A changed criterion breaks a simple pass-rate comparison - Separate fictional verification review: revision A used one acceptance criterion, while revision B uses a different criterion; both have reported pass percentages.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Remote and in-person evaluation plans

A fictional device team compares remote and in-person formative evaluation. Remote sessions save travel time, but the proposed remote setup does not reproduce the intended clinic workspace. No equivalence evidence exists. Discuss the scope and tradeoff.

Role A: Study coordinator: explain the practical advantages and missing environmental coverage.

Role B: Validation manager: ask which study questions each setup can address before recommending a plan.

Possible opening: Remote sessions reduce travel, but this setup doesn't reproduce the intended workspace.

Success checks

- Compare plans against the same intended questions.
- Keep environmental limitations explicit.
- Avoid claiming equivalence or final validation from an unassessed plan.

Add a complication: A sponsor wants both plans labeled equivalent validation options without review.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Usability and Human Factors

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

Several participants misread a label in a formative usability study. A draft report describes them as careless.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: human factors, use error, formative study, summative study.

Model response

The observed difficulty was reading the label correctly in this study. Let's describe the task, design, and use conditions, then investigate contributing factors without assuming carelessness.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. C - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. B - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 • Conversations

1. Misread labels without calling participants careless - Fictional formative usability review: several participants misread a label, but the report supplies no evidence about motivation or attentiveness.
2. Four pauses are an observation, not a diagnosis of confusion - Separate fictional formative study: four of eight technicians paused before selecting a menu item; interviews about their reasons are not yet reviewed.

3. Moderator help limits an unaided-success claim - Separate fictional usability session: one participant completed a setup task after the moderator gave a hint; unaided completion was not observed for that attempt.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A corrected click after a wrong selection

In a fictional formative study, a participant selects the wrong menu item, notices it, and corrects the selection without help. The draft says no use errors occurred. Discuss how to preserve both the error and recovery.

Role A: Usability observer: describe the observed sequence without attributing a cause.

Role B: Design reviewer: ask how recovery should be represented under the study definitions.

Possible opening: The participant recovered independently, but the initial wrong selection still occurred.

Success checks

- Describe both the initial selection and unaided recovery.
- Avoid claiming either flawless use or universal failure.
- Agree to use the study definitions and retain the full observed sequence.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to omit the first selection because the final screen was correct.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A presentation refers to a proposed device pathway as settled, although the regulatory team is still evaluating options.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: 510(k), De Novo, PMA, predicate device.

Model response

Please label the pathway as under evaluation and identify the questions for the regulatory team. We should distinguish a proposed approach from a confirmed regulatory conclusion.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. B - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 · Conversations

1. Request a pathway assessment, not a presumed route - Fictional submission planning: a slide presents the proposed device pathway as settled, although regulatory specialists are still evaluating options.
2. A similar product is not a confirmed predicate - Separate fictional regulatory exercise: a competitor's brochure describes a superficially similar device; no predicate assessment has been completed.

3. A design change needs a scoped regulatory question - Separate fictional planning call: a team proposes changing the device's intended user group; regulatory implications have not been reviewed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A submission date confused with an outcome date

A fictional project calendar targets submission on 1 October. No review duration or agency decision date is confirmed. A launch slide calls 1 October the clearance date. Request a correction and a scoped regulatory planning review.

Role A: Program coordinator: identify the calendar mismatch and request accurate wording.

Role B: Regulatory manager: distinguish a planned submission from an unconfirmed agency outcome.

Possible opening: October first is our submission target, not a confirmed clearance date.

Success checks

- Separate the team's filing target from agency decision timing.
- Request correction of the specific claim.
- Agree the review owner without inventing a regulatory timeline.

Add a complication: Sales asks to keep the date because customers have already seen the draft.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

CASE

A complaint report describes a malfunction but lacks the device identifier and event date. The complaint-handling team needs the available facts promptly.

Teach this move

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

Vocabulary to check: complaint, MDR, malfunction, postmarket surveillance.

Model response

Here is the reported malfunction and the information currently available. The device identifier and event date are missing. Please confirm receipt and handle follow-up through the complaint process.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Second-round challenge

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Language-check answers

1. A - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check. It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.
2. C - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct? This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

05 • Conversations

1. A malfunction complaint with missing identifiers - Fictional complaint handoff: a malfunction is reported, but the device identifier and event date are missing; no reportability assessment exists.

2. A second report may describe the same event - Separate fictional postmarket case: distributor and clinic reports mention the same device reference and date; whether they describe one event or two is unconfirmed.
3. A returned device does not complete the investigation - Separate fictional complaint case: the returned device has arrived at the laboratory, but examination and causality review have not started.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A reporter changes the device reference

In a fictional complaint case, the reporter withdraws the original device reference and supplies a photo that has not been reviewed. The correct identifier remains unconfirmed. Hand the correction to the complaint team without overwriting the history.

Role A: Technical support specialist: distinguish the withdrawn identifier from the unreviewed photo.

Role B: Complaint coordinator: confirm receipt and assign identifier verification.

Possible opening: The reporter says the original reference was wrong; the photo may help, but its identifier has not been verified.

Success checks

- Do not guess the device identity.
- Preserve the correction and source history.
- Confirm the owner of verification and keep reportability decisions separate.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests entering the most common model as a temporary fact.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

CASE

An incoming-material review has identified two nonconforming lots. The investigation is open and disposition has not been authorized.

Teach this move

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Vocabulary to check: nonconformance, supplier CAPA, process validation, lot traceability.

Model response

Two lots have open nonconformance records. The investigation and disposition are still pending. I'll report their status without implying that release or rejection has already been approved.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Second-round challenge

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Language-check answers

1. C - The team has completed the review. 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.
2. B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it. This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

05 • Conversations

1. Two nonconforming lots still await disposition - Fictional incoming-material review: two lots are identified as nonconforming; investigation is open and disposition is unauthorized.

2. A supplier response is not an accepted CAPA - Separate fictional quality case: a supplier submitted a corrective-action response for lot D12, but the receiving quality team has not reviewed it.

3. Process trials complete, validation review pending - Separate fictional manufacturing update: three planned process trials have been executed, but the process-validation report has not been reviewed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A lot reference missing from the inspection attachment

A fictional inspection summary says one lot passed, but its attached measurement sheet has no lot reference. The linkage is unverified and no new release decision is supplied. Explain completed work and the unresolved traceability question.

Role A: Incoming inspector: report the missing linkage without assuming the measurements belong to the stated lot.

Role B: Quality coordinator: assign verification and keep the status appropriately qualified.

Possible opening: The summary names a lot, but we have not verified that this measurement sheet belongs to it.

Success checks

- Identify the precise lot-traceability gap.
- Do not assign evidence by guesswork.
- Agree the verification owner without implying release authority.

Add a complication: A planner asks you to attach the sheet to the nearest lot number in the system.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

State a concern respectfully and propose a practical route forward.

CASE

A trainer is asked to demonstrate a use beyond the materials approved for the session.

Teach this move

Acknowledge the goal without pretending agreement. Name the specific problem and its implication, then ask a focused question or propose a next step. Be direct when a safety or ethical boundary requires it.

Vocabulary to check: labeling, instructions for use, off-label, clinical evidence.

Model response

That request goes beyond the approved training material for this session. I can cover the authorized instructions and route the additional question to the appropriate team for review.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence identifies a testable concern about the proposal. It leaves room for a constructive response.

Second-round challenge

The other person repeats the request more firmly. Restate the specific concern calmly and explain the appropriate next route.

Language-check answers

1. B - The proposal assumes the review is complete; the record shows it is still open. It connects the concern to a specific assumption and record.
2. A - Could we resolve the missing approval before confirming the plan? It names the unresolved condition and a practical next step.

05 • Conversations

1. A demonstration outside the session materials - Fictional clinical-training session: a trainer is asked to demonstrate a use beyond the approved session materials; no procedure is taught in this language exercise.

2. An older training deck conflicts with the current packet - Separate fictional training review: an older deck contains a step absent from the current approved session packet; the reason for the difference is unknown.
3. A testimonial is not comparative clinical evidence - Separate fictional education-material review: a slide says the device is safer than alternatives based only on one clinician's favorable comment.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A requested shortcut to fit the training slot

A fictional coordinator asks a trainer to omit one section from the approved device-training packet to finish ten minutes earlier. The section's purpose and omission implications have not been assessed. Negotiate a review of timing without changing the instructions yourself.

Role A: Clinical trainer: explain the scope concern and propose checking an approved shorter session format.

Role B: Training coordinator: describe the timing constraint and agree to obtain the responsible review.

Possible opening: I can discuss the timing, but I can't assume this section can be omitted without review.

Success checks

- Avoid assuming experience removes the need for reviewed content.
- Keep the session within authorized materials.
- Agree a practical timing or review route without improvising device instructions.

Add a complication: The organizer says experienced participants never need the omitted material.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

FDA: De Novo classification

<https://www.fda.gov/medical-devices/premarket-submissions-selecting-and-preparing-correct-submission/de-novo-classification-request>

FDA: Medical Device Reporting

<https://www.fda.gov/medical-devices/medical-device-safety/medical-device-reporting-mdr-how-report-medical-device-problems>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-06. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Medical Devices English

Professional audience: medical device engineers, product managers, quality and regulatory staff, clinical specialists, manufacturing teams, field-service teams, and device-company leaders

Scope: Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Lesson 01: User Needs and Design Inputs

Original fictional case: A design brief says the device should be "easy to use." It does not identify the intended users or use environment.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: user need: Something a user needs to accomplish in a particular context. / design input: A documented requirement that guides a product's design. / intended use: The purpose for which a product is designed and represented to be used. / traceability: The ability to follow an item's history, source, requirements, or records through documented links.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Who will use it, for which task, and in what environment? Let's turn "easy to use" into specific user needs and requirements that the team can review.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt this material for a teaching session

1. Ask me one brief planning question covering learner support needs, group size and available time. Offer a default of two B2 learners and 20 minutes. Stop and wait; use the default only if I choose it.
2. Create a timed plan using the supplied case or dialogue, its actual terminology and one narrow language goal. Include an individual first attempt, partner exchange, focused feedback and a retry. Keep the total within the time I choose. State what the learner should be able to communicate at the end.
3. Provide separate role cards for two or three professional speakers. Each card needs an objective, known information and one question to resolve. Label any invented private information as a variation; do not contradict shared facts. Do not place the model answer on the learner cards.
4. Add a B1 support option with useful frames, a B2 independent task and a C1 extension involving a plausible competing constraint. Maintain the same professional meaning across levels. Explain unfamiliar terms without removing the field's normal language. Include a workable solo alternative.
5. Put teacher notes and suggested responses in a clearly separate section after the learner material. Include likely misunderstandings and a short observation checklist for facts, clarity, tone and next step. Accept multiple successful formulations. Finish with one exit question and a delayed-recall task; identify what the teacher should check before use.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Medical Devices English

Professional audience: medical device engineers, product managers, quality and regulatory staff, clinical specialists, manufacturing teams, field-service teams, and device-company leaders

Scope: Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Lesson 01: User Needs and Design Inputs

Original fictional case: A design brief says the device should be "easy to use." It does not identify the intended users or use environment.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: user need: Something a user needs to accomplish in a particular context. / design input: A documented requirement that guides a product's design. / intended use: The purpose for which a product is designed and represented to be used. / traceability: The ability to follow an item's history, source, requirements, or records through documented links.

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Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Who will use it, for which task, and in what environment? Let's turn "easy to use" into specific user needs and requirements that the team can review.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Match the language to the listener

1. Choose a short message or utterance from the reference and quote it exactly. Identify its purpose and likely audience. Ask me to choose a new audience: a close colleague, a decision-maker, or an external reader who may not know the jargon. Stop and wait.
2. Ask me to adapt that message for the chosen reader, keeping its facts and degree of certainty unchanged. Offer a short frame only if I request help. Wait for my attempt before showing alternatives.
3. Discuss at most three choices in my version: directness, specialist vocabulary and interpersonal tone. Explain when a direct request is clearer than extra politeness, and when an unfamiliar abbreviation needs expansion. Avoid cultural stereotypes or claims that one nationality always communicates a certain way.
4. Show two natural alternatives, such as a concise spoken version and a more explicit written version. Explain the tradeoff in each. Do not turn a request into an order, a possibility into a promise, or a pending decision into approval.
5. Ask me to respond to one realistic follow-up from the new reader, then wait. Finish by asking me to adapt the message for a second audience without losing its core meaning. Give feedback only after the attempt.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level